without the support of Indira Gandhi, who expected a political alliance between her Congress party and Farooq's National Conference. But being advised by his party to be independent, Farooq first vacillated and then confronted the Congress even though Indira Gandhi, in an unprecedented move, chose to campaign in the Jammu and Kashmir state elections. Relations between Farooq Abdullah and Indira Gandhi further strained after he chose to engage openly with some opposition leaders at a three-day National Opposition conclave that he had hosted in Srinagar in October 1983. It set the stage for the entry of a newly appointed Governor, Jagmohan, who was a trusted lieutenant of the Gandhi family. Farooq was replaced by his brother-in-law G. M. Shah as Indira Gandhi was reluctant to follow Jagmohan's advice of imposing Governor's rule by article 92 of the Jammu and Kashmir Constitution. Indira Gandhi's intention was apparently only to discipline the young Farooq Abdullah, but his removal only gave Farooq's popularity a boost, and it has been argued that Farooq's ouster had led to the insurgency that devastated the state since 1989.

Kashmir had also begun to see the revival of Islamist political parties in the 1980s. The MUF was established in August 1986 by a number of Muslim parties led by Jamaat-e-Islami (including the People's Conference), the Ummat-e-Islami and the Ittehad-ul-Muslimeen.[3] Simultaneously, Rajiv Gandhi worked towards the restoration of a constitutional government in Jammu and Kashmir. A dialogue with Farooq led to the Rajiv-Farooq accord in November 1986, but the Kashmiris viewed this initiative as a blow to their self-respect. Farooq lost much of the goodwill that had followed his ouster in 1983. By 1987, the stage was set for a political confrontation between the Jamaat and the National Conference; the Jamaat had, by then, emerged as the leader of the MUF under the leadership of Syed Ali Shah Geelani. He had steadily worked towards building its influence, since 1979, through *Madrasas* which were allowed to proliferate by Sheikh Abdullah. Apparently, his aim was to keep New Delhi on the edge by keeping alive the possibility of religious revival, in case it interfered with his government's freedom within Jammu and Kashmir.